

CCD Minutes – Board Mtg Dec.7, 2025

Attendees

- **Board/Committee Members & Participants:**

Philip Ogston; Myra Mitchell; Valerie Allendorf; Larry Lankford; Charles Wallner; Deven Corzine; Bonnie Carpenter; Audrey Eyman; Richard House; Darlene Underwood;

Key Topics & Detailed Summaries

1) Committee Leader Election – Policy & Procedure

What was proposed:

A formal policy to elect committee/work-group leaders with a **default 12-month term**, unless a specific commission sets a different term. Process includes nomination announcements (≥ 3 weeks prior to vote), self-nominations, option for **co-leaders** (approved by Executive Committee), recommended candidate statements using **GWC** ("Gets it, Wants it, Can do it"), quorum/simple majority, flexibility to use **ranked choice or run-off** if needed, and option for **secret ballots** in contested elections. Verbal candidate statements can be requested.

Discussion highlights:

- Audrey initially advocated for **two-year terms** to improve continuity; group agreed default stays 12 months but specific commissions can set longer terms.
- Deven suggested default **ranked-choice** for >2 nominees; group retained flexibility case-by-case.
- Charles will format this as formal **policy & procedure**; signatures required post-approval.

Outcome:

Policy approved with edits (allow in-person statements; typo fixes).

2) Committee Charters – Opening Crew & Closing Crew

Opening Crew Charter (Purpose/Scope/Deliverables):

- Open/set up hall for **Monday & Saturday contra dances**; maintain list of standard opening activities; perform opening with volunteers; coordinate with Closing Crew. No standing

budget; request supplies/equipment to board as needed; volunteers **may be offered free admission voucher** to a later dance.

Closing Crew Charter (Purpose/Scope/Deliverables):

- Reset/clean and secure hall after dances; maintain closing checklist; coordinate with Opening Crew; ensure building is **secured** (liaison with sound crew and keyholders). Similar resource note; volunteers may be offered **free admission voucher** to a later dance.

Discussion highlights:

- Clarity on leader responsibility and volunteer management (Darlene's question).
- Voucher scope debated: historically **Monday-only**; suggestion to leave as any dance for now, with committees to recommend edits later.
- Administrative note: keep **permanent charters** separate from a **living roster** listing current leaders/board contacts/terms.

Outcomes:

- **Opening Crew Charter approved** (Myra noted as board contact in discussion, but names to live in roster).
 - **Closing Crew Charter approved** (Philip discussed as board contact; same roster approach).
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3) Scheduling Committee / Scheduler Role & Governance

Draft charter outline (under discussion):

- Book bands & callers for Monday/Saturday dances; maintain talent relations; publish schedules; ensure presence; maintain **active talent contact list**; coordinate **hospitality/housing** for traveling talent; discretionary funds above standard rates per board policy; payments via **Treasurer or designee**.

Governance & oversight considerations:

- Debate on **leader requirement**: elected board member vs. open role (Myra raised capacity concerns; Philip emphasized trust/oversight).
- **Financial oversight** emphasized (Charles): scheduler decisions influence major expenditures, so clear accountability to Treasurer/Board.
- **Fairness & transparency**: scheduler writes procedure **before** scheduling; board reviews; reporting every meeting; completed schedules due **Dec 1 / Jun 1** for next half-year.

- **Continuity options** (Audrey): 2-year term, co-lead pipeline, or a **long-term organizational policy** for scheduling with controlled amendment process.
- **Committee size & membership control**: leader can invite/decline volunteers, but board can mandate size as needed; add **leader removal** procedure.
- **Conflict of interest**: Reaffirm board **COI form**; action to **re-read and re-sign** for current board.
- **Handoff process**: defined overlap and responsibilities to ensure smooth transition (e.g., who manages pre-booked January gigs if leader changes in January).
- **Bands/Callers Spokesperson** concept to handle complaints independently of scheduler.

Outcome:

- Charter **previewed**; sentiment to incorporate feedback and return for a formal vote (no final vote recorded in these sessions).

4) Scheduling Report (First Half of 2026)

- Final confirmations sent to bands **Nov 30**; schedule published to website team **Dec 5 (early AM)**; John McCain (sound) informed; board requested receiving confirmed list as well.
- Note on accessibility for caller **Bob Duffy** (bad knees; may sit while calling); consider a **stool/riser** to improve visibility.
- **DJ Contra**: Deven to take lead coordinating with Kenny, Polly, Darlene; plan to formalize **DJ Contra** as an auxiliary-dance commission.

5) Recognition & Appreciation

- Proposal to recognize **Trish** (10+ years running Waltz Night; stepped down) and **Kurt** (prior board service and sound). Debate whether funding comes from board donations vs. CCD funds.
- **Outcome**: Allocate **up to \$80** to reimburse Social Secretary (working with Charles) for certificates/flowers or appropriate tokens; present Trish's recognition at **Jan 31 Waltz Night**; Kurt's recognition at a suitable upcoming dance (likely when he does sound).
- Longer-term idea: create a **Recognition Committee** with a yearly budget.

6) New Year's Eve Dance (NYE)

- **Status:** Confirmed—Caller **Kenny Greer** (format TBD: gendered vs. gender-free), band **Trillium**; potluck **6:30–7:30 PM**; beginner orientation and dance **8:00–midnight**.
 - **Setup/Cleanup:** Myra (setup including potluck logistics), Philip (cleanup coordination); tables to be located; avoid flashing lights; consider **sparkly/ambient lighting** if volunteers available (Josh/Kurt) and time allows.
 - **Facilities:** Possible use of **Masonic room** for lesson if needed; caution about food on carpet upstairs.
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7) PigTown (Annual Weekend Event)

- **Volunteers:** Announced at dances; list building; repeat volunteers returning; aim to attract newer/local dancers via **à la carte** options. Need improved **flyer presence** and distribution (including Berea Christmas School).
 - **Lighting Idea:** Ambient/sparkly (not strobe).
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8) Finance Committee – Talent Pay Proposal

- Draft presented by Larry; **uniform per-person pay** for caller and each band member (exceptions: very large bands; special case for 2-person bands to avoid a pay cut vs. prior flat band rates). Final numbers contingent on **Recruitment Committee** funding needs.
 - **Recruitment Committee Timeline:** First meeting next weekend; expect 1–2 additional meetings; target **Jan–Feb** for proposal. Board intends to consider **talent pay** and **recruitment budget** together for balance.
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9) Support for Wyoming Fine Arts Center (WFAC)

- Consider ways to **assist fundraising** (e.g., ramp/accessibility, sound improvements) aligned to CCD mission. Immediate matching-grant deadline **Dec 31** noted.
 - **Actions discussed:** Announce donation link at dances; display WFAC poster; explore pooled CCD/member donations for a unified **“Save Our Space”** message. Philip & Charles to engage WFAC leadership about **year-long collaboration** options without committing specific CCD funds yet.
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Key Decisions

1. **Adopt Committee Leader Election Policy & Procedure** (with edit to allow in-person candidate statements; secret ballots option; flexible voting methods).
2. **Approve Opening Crew Charter** (permanent charter; names/terms to be tracked in living roster).
3. **Approve Closing Crew Charter** (permanent charter; living roster for contacts/terms).
4. **Allocate up to \$80** to Social Secretary for recognition of **Trish** and **Kurt** (timing/format as appropriate).
5. **Proceed with NYE Dance Plan** (potluck timing, talent booked; setup/cleanup plan).

(Scheduling Committee charter was discussed and refined but not finalized for vote in these sessions.)

Action Items

Governance & Policy

- **Charles:** Format the approved **Election Policy & Procedure** in formal policy document; arrange for **signatures** from board members.
- **Executive Committee:** Incorporate feedback into **Scheduling Committee Charter** (continuity term option, handoff process, fairness procedure, COI acknowledgment, committee size guidance, ombudsperson role) and bring back for vote.
- **Board (All):** **Re-read and re-sign Conflict of Interest forms**; coordinate collection/logistics at a dance.

Operations: Opening/Closing & Scheduling

- **Secretary (Myra):** Maintain **standard opening/closing checklists** as living documents; update living roster for leaders/contacts/terms (post-election).
- **Closing Crew Lead (currently Philip, per discussion):** Ensure secure lock-up coordination with Sound Crew; track "last-out" responsibilities.
- **Scheduling Team (Bonnie/Deven):**
 - Send **confirmed first-half 2026 schedule** to full board and sound team.
 - Explore **stool/riser** solution for Bob Duffy's visibility.
 - Advance **DJ Contra** plan; draft the auxiliary-dance commission description for future formalization.

Events

- **NYE Setup (Myra):** Locate tables; organize potluck layout (6:30–7:30 PM); coordinate beginner lesson logistics; recruit volunteer(s) for ambient lighting (Josh/Kurt).

- **NYE Cleanup (Philip):** Confirm volunteers; bring extra cleanup supplies; ensure post-midnight lockup.
- **Recognition (Social Secretary & Charles):** Purchase certificates/flowers/chocolate as appropriate; present **Trish** on **Jan 31 Waltz Night**; plan timing for **Kurt**. Submit receipts for reimbursement ($\leq \$80$).
- **PigTown (Valerie/Autumn, all):** Continue volunteer recruitment; improve **flyer distribution** (including Berea); coordinate snack/catering logistics.

Finance & External Relations

- **Finance Committee (Larry):** Hold on talent pay proposal pending **Recruitment Committee** funding plan; prepare consolidated recommendation for board decision (target **Jan–Feb 2026**).
 - **Recruitment Committee (Audrey, et al.):** Conduct initial and follow-up meetings; deliver proposal **Jan–Feb**.
 - **WFAC Liaison (Philip & Charles):** Set meeting with WFAC to discuss **year-long support options**; in near term, arrange **dance announcements & poster** display to encourage donations by **Dec 31**. Consider pooled CCD/member contribution campaign messaging ("**Save Our Space**").
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Open Questions / Items for Next Meeting

- Finalize **Scheduling Committee Charter** language (leader requirements, term, handoff, oversight, ombudsperson).
- Decide whether volunteer **free-admission vouchers** should be **Monday-only** or **any dance**, based on committee recommendation.
- Review **talent pay vs. recruitment** combined budget proposal; set implementation timing (likely after PigTown).
- Solidify **DJ Contra** governance (commission charter) and calendar slotting.
- Confirm **NYE** details (caller format; lighting volunteers; lesson location).